Introducing: Aquaculture Reports

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Editorial

Introducing: *Aquaculture Reports*

On a global scale, the growth of aquaculture remains impressive but has slowed slightly during the last decade (FAO, 2012, 2014). Growth is especially robust in the low and middle-income countries outside of Asia, but Asia (and particularly China) continues to dominate overall production (Fig. 1). In the coming years, fish production from capture fisheries will not increase significantly, if at all. Thus, demand for cultured fish will increase with the growing population and rising incomes in the low and middle-income countries, but how much and where aquaculture will grow remains uncertain (Bostock et al., 2010; World Bank, 2013). A major part of population growth (and therefore fish demand) will no doubt occur in the fast-growing economies of the global south, often in urban centres (UN-DESAPD, 2014).

A large part of the production growth in the last 30 years has been achieved with a limited number of species that have gained global significance because of their large production volumes and export value. For these species, which include carps, Atlantic salmon, tilapias, penaeid shrimps, and catfish, pioneering and innovative research was required in production systems, genetics, reproduction, husbandry and nutrition, disease prevention and control. Beyond a few emerging species of shellfish, seaweeds, and molluscs, the total number of species used in aquaculture is actually enormous, around 600 according to the last FAO report (2014).

While not all of these species are likely to attain the global importance of the carps, tilapia and salmon, the culture of many of them will develop further in the coming years to contribute to food security and livelihoods in their own regions. For example, the production of sea bass, flatfish and large yellow croaker in China has steadily increased to 0.13, 0.12 and 0.10 million tonnes, respectively, in 2013 (Ministry of Agriculture, China 2014). The development of these new industries may require species-specific research on genetics, physiology and nutrition as much of the knowledge generated in the past cannot be directly applied to other species. Thus, there is a growing need to publish the scientific discoveries related to the development of new aquaculture species.

Traditionally, aquaculture science was concerned mostly with keeping, reproducing and feeding the fish stock to achieve optimum production. In recent years, more attention has been going towards the context in which aquaculture systems develop. The clientele for "aquaculture knowledge" are not only the producers, but include a range of decision makers at various levels who need to consider the social and environmental impact of aquaculture operations, their food safety and food security aspects, and the need for institutional support for the aquaculture sector (e.g., in the form of subsidies, training, extension). Such research into the development of aquaculture is multi-disciplinary, looking at aquaculture not only as the efficient and profitable production of fish biomass, but also as a sustainable industry that is part of a value chain (Little et al., 2012). Aquaculture is also a provisioning ecosystem service that needs to be in balance with other ecosystem services and biodiversity and to respect its surrounding wetlands (Volpe et al., 2010; Russi et al., 2013). The aquaculture industry also wants to present itself to consumers as a responsible producer of safe and healthy food products (Smith et al., 2010).

Aquaculture, Elsevier's leading aquaculture journal has since its start in 1972 focused on publishing novel and innovative research on farming of aquatic organisms of world-wide interest. Over the years, the number of manuscripts submitted to the journal has grown but a large proportion of the submissions are rejected because of limited regional appeal, a focus on minor-use species, or the lack of space. Nevertheless, many of the rejected manuscripts have a high scientific quality as well as the vital industry focus that is essential for developing innovative, economically and environmentally feasible systems of regional or global importance. To provide a platform for these papers, Elsevier now launches a new aquaculture journal called *Aquaculture Reports*. This new, open access journal will be published in close cooperation with *Aquaculture* and will focus on development of aquaculture in various parts of the world.

Aquaculture Reports will publish original research papers and reviews documenting outstanding science and focus on emerging areas of aquaculture, such as integrated aquaculture, rural and urban aquaculture and offshore aquaculture. The journal will be especially interested in publishing information on new aquaculture species and production systems. Papers having industry-relevant research as priority and encompassing product development research or current industry practice are encouraged. Submissions may cover feeding management, fish nutrition and health, genetics, development biology, physiology and life cycle; as well as production systems and interdisciplinary research regarding the sustainable management of aquatic resources and resulting impacts on people and the environment. The full aims and scope of the new journal can be found on the journal's website. The open access publication fee for this journal is $1000, excluding taxes. Publication fees will be discounted by 90% during the first year (2015).

Three executive editors (one for each of three regions) will oversee the editorial process of the new journal: Wenbing Zhang, Ocean University of China, Qingdao, China (Asia-Pacific); Wagner

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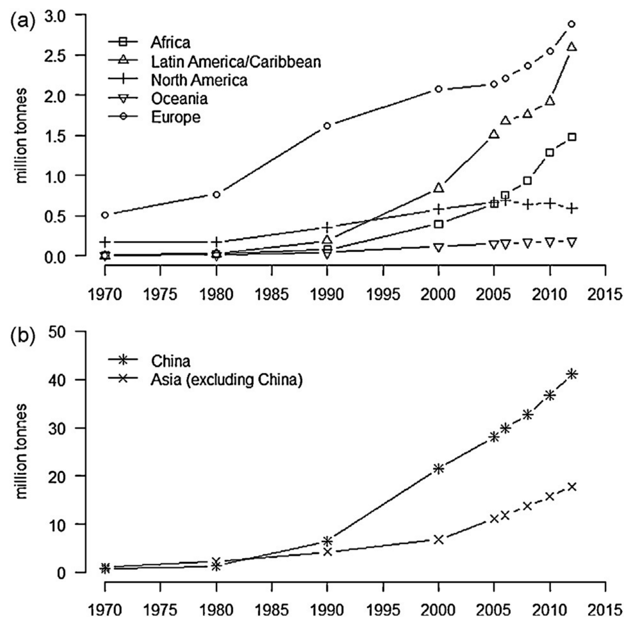

Fig. 1. Aquaculture production in the world. Based on FAO (2012, 2014).

Valenti, São Paulo State University, Brazil (Americas); and Anne van Dam, UNESCO-IHE Institute for Water Education, The Netherlands (Africa-Europe). These editors bring to the journal wide regional and international experiences and look forward to working with the international aquaculture community. The Editors would like to invite authors to submit manuscripts with original research or review papers to the new journal, and also welcome proposals for special issues. We look forward to working with authors and reviewers in an efficient but thorough review process to produce a high-quality journal that will be useful for scientists, practitioners and decision-makers.

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